Topic 25 — UP Special

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Governor of Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश) | UP Legislative Assembly | Strength of UP LA | UP Legislative Council | Strength & composition of UP LC | Lok Sabha (लोकसभा) seats from UP | Rajya Sabha (राज्यसभा) seats from UP | High Court of Judicature at Allahabad (इलाहाबाद) | Establishment of Allahabad HC | Lucknow (लखनऊ) Bench | UP Reorganisation / Creation of Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड) | Administrative divisions of UP | Official language of UP | Uttar Pradesh State Election Commission (निर्वाचन आयोग) | UPPSC (उत्तर प्रदेश लोक सेवा आयोग) | UP Finance Commission (वित्त आयोग) | UP Lokayukta (लोकायुक्त) | UP Panchayati Raj (पंचायती राज) | Urban (नगरीय) Local Bodies in UP

Sources baked in: Arts. 243I / 243K / 243Y / 243ZA / 315–323, UP Panchayat Raj Act 1947, Kshettra–Zila Adhiniyam 1961, Municipalities Act 1916, Municipal Corporation Act 1959, Lokayukta Act 1975, UPPCS 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — Panchayat polls = **SEC not ECI** (2023); no "Panchayati Raj Commission of India"; UPPSC functions extended by **UP Legislature** (2021); HQ **Prayagraj**; intermediate tier = **Kshetra Panchayat Last verified:** August 2026 **Current Affairs:** Women in UP PRIs/ULBs = **50% by State law** (Constitution's floor is still 1/3). Nagar Nigam count **moves** — mark the **three types**, not a frozen headcount. **Noida / Greater Noida / YEIDA** remain industrial townships, not Nigams **Consolidated UP Special desk:** UP Special Topic 3 — Polity, Administration & Local Government (8-chapter UP Special subject)

Current Affairs (what the year actually tests)

Newest first. One event, one fact.

Year	What happened	What you mark
2025	Devipatan division districts (geography paper)	**Gonda** division: Bahraich, Balrampur, Gonda, Shravasti
2023	UP in Parliament	RS **31** and LS **80** — **both** true
2022	LA strengths "NOT matched"	**Manipur 62** is wrong (**60**). UP **403** is right
2007	Uttaranchal renamed	**Uttarakhand, 1 Jan 2007**
2000	Reorganisation	**9 Nov** · LA 425→**403** · LS 85→**80** · RS 34→**31**
1989	Urdu	**Second** official language
1948	Lucknow Bench	Oudh Chief Court **merged**, not a new HC
2023	Who conducts Panchayat elections?	**SEC** — not ECI, not a "PR Commission of India"
2021	Who extends UPPSC functions?	**UP State Legislature** (321)
2013	Union Lokpal (लोकपाल) Act	UP already had Lokayukta **1975**

Year	What happened	What you mark
1866	Allahabad HC	Letters Patent **17 Mar**; first seat **Agra** (आगरा)

Frame

UP's meat is **numbers plus one geography of power**: Lucknow runs the government; Prayagraj runs the High Court **and UPPSC**; Uttarakhand (9 Nov 2000) is why 425/85/34 became **403/80/31**. Local polls = SEC; recruitment = UPPSC. **Noida is not a Nagar Nigam.**

Governor of Uttar Pradesh

State Governor (राज्यपाल) under Arts. 153–162. Raj Bhavan **Lucknow**. First = **Sarojini Naidu** (15 Aug **1947**). **No Art. 371** special provision for UP.

- **Oath (Art. 159):** before the **Chief Justice of the Allahabad High Court** (or a person appointed by the President)
- **First woman Governor** of an Indian State. Died in office, Lucknow, **2 Mar 1949**
- **Not the first CM:** first CM = **Govind Ballabh Pant**. First woman CM = **Sucheta Kripalani (1963–67)**
- **Appointment / term:** President; **5 years**; holds office during pleasure; can be transferred; one person may be Governor of more than one State (153)
- **Council of Ministers (91st):** including the CM, **not more than 15%** of the LA. 15% of **403** ≈ **60**. Floor in any State is **12**. Collectively responsible to the **LA**
- **Secretariat:Lucknow** (with Raj Bhavan and Vidhan Bhavan). Do not raata a 2026 occupant's name as if it were in the Constitution

> **Logic:** First Governor ≠ G.B. Pant (**Pant was CM**). Raj Bhavan is **Lucknow**, not Prayagraj. UP has **no** 371 special article.

Uttar Pradesh Legislative Assembly

403 elected — largest LA in India. Vidhan Bhavan, **Lucknow**. Age **25**. 5 years. Money Bills only here.

Bicameral: UP is one of **six** Council States — Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश).

- **Before Uttarakhand:425**. Seat freeze till the census after **2026** — so **403** is the number the paper uses
- **Article:170** (composition) · **172** (5 years) · **174** (summon (आहूत करना) / prorogue / dissolve)
- Direct, FPTP, territorial seats. SC/ST reserved under **332**. Anglo-Indian nomination (**333**) ended by the **104th**

- Money Bill: only in the LA, on the Governor's recommendation. LC has **14 days**, recommendatory
- **Quorum (गणपूर्ति) (189):10 members or 1/10** of total membership (सदन की कुल सदस्य संख्या का), **whichever is greater**
- **Speaker:** elected from among MLAs. Resigns to the **Deputy Speaker** (179). Continues after dissolution (विघटन) until the new House first meets
- **Presidential college:** only the **403 elected MLAs** vote (not LC, not nominated). UP MLA vote-value is the **highest** among States (textbook **208**)

Other large Assemblies (only to not mix): West Bengal 294 · Maharashtra 288 · Bihar 243 · Tamil Nadu (नाडु) 234 · Madhya Pradesh 230.

> **Logic:** UP LA ≠ 500 (that is Art. 170's **maximum**). ≠ 425 still (that was pre-**9 Nov 2000**).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q14

Which one of the following pairs is **NOT** correctly matched?

A. Manipur — 62 B. Goa (गोवा) — 40 C. Uttar Pradesh — 403 D. Uttarakhand — 70

Show answer

Ans: A — Manipur is 60, not 62. UP **403** and Uttarakhand **70** are correct.

Trap: UP LA = 500 because Art. 170 says 500. **500 is the constitutional maximum, not UP's strength.** Trap: UP LA = 425 still. **That was pre-9 Nov 2000.**

Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council

100 members. Cannot be dissolved; **1/3 retire every 2 years**; age **30**. Art. 171 cap is **1/3 of LA (= 134)** and min **40** — UP chose **100**.

- **Term:6 years**. Can only be **abolished** under Art. **169**, not dissolved
- **Chairman:** elected **from among LC members** — not the Governor, not the CM. Resigns to the **Deputy Chairman** (183)
- Does **not** vote for **President** (only elected MLAs do) · does **not** originate Money Bills

UP's 100 seats — five streams (must add to 100) - **36** elected by **local bodies** (municipalities, district boards…) - **8 graduates** of 3 years' standing, resident in UP - **8 teachers** in institutions not lower than secondary, 3 years' standing - **36** elected by **MLAs**, from persons who are **not** MLAs - **12 nominated by the Governor** — literature, science, art, **co-operative movement**, social service

36 + 8 + 8 + 36 + 12 = **100**. Graduates and teachers are **1/12 each** in Art. 171; UP's statute rounds them to **8 + 8**. Nomination in an LC includes **co-operative movement**; RS nomination of 12 does **not**.

> **Logic:** Cap is **134**; actual House is **100**. LC cannot be dissolved like the LA — only **abolished**. LA vs LC: 403 / 25 / 5y / Money Bills vs 100 / 30 / 6y / no dissolution.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q13 (the article-rule, which UP must also satisfy)

The Legislative Council may not have more than one-third of the LA, and must have at least forty members. **Both true.**

Trap: UP LC = 1/3 of 403 = 134. **The cap is 134; the actual House is 100.** Trap: LC can be dissolved like the LA. **Cannot. 2018: a Council can be abolished, not dissolved.**

Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha seats from Uttar Pradesh

LS 80 (largest) · RS 31 (largest). Before 9 Nov 2000: LS **85**, RS **34**. Uttarakhand took **5** LS + **3** RS.

House	UP now	Before 9 Nov 2000	All-India rank
Lok Sabha (लोकसभा)	**80**	**85**	**Largest** (next: Maharashtra 48)
Rajya Sabha (राज्यसभा)	**31**	**34**	**Largest** (next: Maharashtra 19)

- **Reservation in the 80:17 Scheduled Caste (अनुसूचित जाति)** seats. **Zero Scheduled Tribe (अनुसूचित जनजाति)** Lok Sabha seats from UP
- **How the 31 RS seats are filled:** elected by the **403 MLAs**, proportional representation by single transferable vote, **6-year** term, **1/3** retire every two years. The Governor does **not** nominate anyone to the Rajya Sabha

> **Logic:** UP sends **80** Lok Sabha members and **31** Rajya Sabha members — not **85** / **34**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q14

1. Uttar Pradesh has 31 seats allotted for Rajya Sabha.
2. Eighty members of the Lok Sabha are elected from Uttar Pradesh.

A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither

Show answer

Ans: C — Both. 31 and 80.

Trap: UP LS = 85 still. **80 after Uttarakhand.** Trap: RS 34. **31.** Trap: only 1 of the two 2023 statements is true. **Both.**

High Court of Judicature at Allahabad

Established 1866 (Letters Patent **17 March 1866**) under the Indian High Courts Act **1861**. Principal seat **Prayagraj**. First sat **Agra**. Lucknow is a **Bench**, not a second HC.

- Birth name: High Court of Judicature for the **North-Western Provinces**. First seat **Agra** (1866), replacing the Sadr (सद्र) Diwani (दीवानी) Adalat. Shifted to **Allahabad in 1869**. Present name by

supplementary Letters Patent **1919**

- First Chief Justice: Sir **Walter Morgan**
- **Lucknow Bench:United Provinces High Courts (Amalgamation) Order, 1948**. The **Chief Court of Oudh** (Lucknow, set up **1925**) was merged. There is **no** third permanent bench (Meerut (मेरठ)/Noida demands are not law)
- Who sits where: Lucknow = old **Avadh / Oudh** districts — classically **12**: Lucknow, Unnao, Raebareli, Sitapur, Hardoi, Lakhimpur Kheri, Gonda, Bahraich, Barabanki, Faizabad/Ayodhya, Sultanpur, Pratapgarh. Districts later carved from these (Amethi, Shravasti, Balrampur…) also go to Lucknow. **Rest of UP: Prayagraj**
- Sanctioned strength **160** — **largest High Court in India**. Jurisdiction = whole of **Uttar Pradesh only**. Uttarakhand HC = **Nainital** from **2000**
- **Not** a Chartered High Court of **1862** (Bombay, Calcutta, Madras)

> **Logic:** Allahabad HC = **1866**, first seat **Agra** — not 1862 Chartered. Lucknow = **Bench**. UK since 2000 = **Nainital**.

Official language of Uttar Pradesh

Hindi in Devanagari = official (UP Official Language Act **1951**). **Urdu = second official (1989)**. Art. **345**.

- Legislature (Art. **210**): Hindi / official language of the State / English
- High Court (Art. **348**): authoritative language of the HC is **English** unless the Governor, with the President's consent, authorises Hindi. Do not write "Allahabad HC works only in Hindi"
- Union OL Rules 1976: UP is **Region A** (correspondence with the Centre in Hindi)
- Both **Hindi and Urdu** are in the Eighth Schedule (आठवीं अनुसूची). That is **not** what made Urdu UP's second official language — the **1989 State Act** did

> **Logic:** Urdu is **second**, 1989 — not the official language. There is **no** national-language article.

UP Reorganisation / Creation of Uttarakhand

Uttar Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2000 — 9 November 2000, 27th State. Born as **Uttaranchal**; renamed **Uttarakhand 1 January 2007**.

- Hill districts of **Garhwal (गढ़वाल) and Kumaon (कुमाऊँ) — 13 districts** at birth: Almora (अल्मोड़ा), Bageshwar (बागेश्वर), Chamoli (चमोली), Champawat (चंपावत), Dehradun (देहरादून), Haridwar (हरिद्वार), Nainital, Pauri (पौड़ी) Garhwal, Pithoragarh (पिथौरागढ़), Rudraprayag (रुद्रप्रयाग), Tehri (टिहरी) Garhwal, Udham Singh Nagar (ऊधम सिंह नगर), Uttarkashi (उत्तरकाशी)
- Capital **Dehradun** (देहरादून) (temporary); Gairsain is the summer-capital project — do not treat Gairsain as the 2000 statutory capital

- High Court **Nainital**. First Governor **Surjit Singh Barnala** · first CM **Nityanand Swami (स्वामी)**
- UP numbers that moved: LA **425** → **403** · LS **85** → **80** · RS **34** → **31**. Uttarakhand LA = **70**

Same winter: Chhattisgarh **1 Nov 2000** · Uttarakhand **9 Nov** · Jharkhand **15 Nov**.

> **Logic:** Uttarakhand ≠ 1 November 2000 (that is **Chhattisgarh**). Always-named-Uttarakhand is false — **Uttaranchal till 2007**.

Administrative divisions of Uttar Pradesh

18 Commissioner divisions · 75 districts. A division is headed by a **Commissioner** (executive), not by the High Court Bench.

- **The 18 divisions:** Agra · Aligarh (अलीगढ़) · **Ayodhya** (old Faizabad) · Azamgarh · Bareilly · Basti · Chitrakoot (चित्रकूट) · **Devipatan** (HQ **Gonda**) · Gorakhpur (गोरखपुर) · Jhansi (झांसी) · Kanpur (कानपुर) · Lucknow · Meerut · Mirzapur (मिर्ज़ापुर) · Moradabad · **Prayagraj** · Saharanpur · Varanasi (वाराणसी)
- **Devipatan (2025 geography fact):** Bahraich · Balrampur · Gonda · Shravasti
- Do not raata a brittle tehsil/block count

> **Logic:** UP has **18** divisions, not 17. Faizabad division = **Ayodhya**. Devipatan ≠ Lucknow — HQ **Gonda**.

Bodies · Panchayats · Municipalities

Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission

State PSC · HQ Prayagraj · born 1 April 1937. Governor appoints; **President** removes (after SC on misbehaviour); age **62** / 6y.

- **Article:315–323**
- **Extend functions (321):Uttar Pradesh State Legislature** — not the President, not the PM, not DoPT
- **Further office (319):** Chair may later be UPSC Chair or Chair of **another** SPSC — not a random Union/State post
- Conducts Combined State / Upper Subordinate (PCS), **RO-ARO**, and other State services the 321 law / Governor's regulations give it
- ≠ **UPSC** (संघ लोक सेवा आयोग) (Union, Delhi) · **UP SEC** (local polls, Lucknow) · **Accountant General** (CAG (भारत के नियंत्रक-महालेखापरीक्षक)'s field officer)

> **Logic:** UPPSC HQ = **Prayagraj**, not Lucknow. The Governor who appoints does **not** remove.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q133

The functions of the State Public Service Commission (राज्य लोक सेवा आयोग) of Uttar Pradesh can be extended by—

A. Prime Minister B. Union Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions C. The President D. Uttar Pradesh State Legislature

Show answer

Ans: D — Art. 321.

Trap: UPPSC sits in Lucknow with the Secretariat. **Prayagraj.** Trap: the Governor who appoints also removes. **President removes.**

Uttar Pradesh State Election Commission

Local-body election authority — Arts. **243K + 243ZA**. HQ **Lucknow**. Governor appoints; removed like an **HC judge**. Conducts **Panchayat and ULB** polls — **not** MLA/MP/President.

- **One** Commission for both Panchayats and municipalities
- Superintendence, direction and control of **electoral rolls and elections** to Gram / Kshetra / Zila Panchayats **and** Nagar Nigam / Palika / Panchayat
- The State cannot starve the SEC of staff to delay polls (*Kishan Singh Tomar*, 2006). Elections must be held before the term ends

> **Logic:** Panchayat polls = **SEC not ECI** (2023). There is **no** "Panchayati Raj Commission of India." SEC ≠ CEC's State office. Removal like **HC judge**, not SC judge.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q17

All elections to the Panchayats are conducted by—

A. State Legislature B. State Election Commission C. Election Commission of India D. Panchayati Raj Commission of India

Show answer

Ans: B. There is **no** "Panchayati Raj Commission of India."

Trap: SEC = ECI's State office. **Separate constitutional office.** Trap: SEC removed like an SC judge. **Like an HC judge.**

Uttar Pradesh Finance Commission (State Finance Commission)

Governor constitutes every 5 years (243I). Same Commission reviews **municipal** finances (**243Y**). ≠ Union FC (280, President).

- Job: how to share State taxes with PRIs and ULBs; grants-in-aid; measures to improve their tax base
- **Report:** to the **Governor**, who lays it in **both Houses** (UP is bicameral) with an **action-taken** note
- From the 10th FC onwards the Union FC also writes PRI/ULB grants; that does **not** abolish the State FC

> **Logic:** SFC report → **Governor**, not President. **One** SFC, two articles (243I and 243Y) — not two commissions.

Uttar Pradesh Lokayukta

Statutory ombudsman — U.P. Lokayukta and Up-Lokayukta Act, 1975. Up-Lokayukta = number-two. ≠ Lokpal (Union, 2013).

- **First in India:Maharashtra, 1971** (not UP)
- **Appoint:Governor**, after consultation with the **Chief Justice of the Allahabad High Court** and the **Leader of Opposition**
- Typically a retired **HC / SC judge**. Term (1975 Act): classically **8 years**, **no reappointment** as Lokayukta — do not copy the Lokpal's 5-year / 70-year formula onto UP
- Inquire into allegations against ministers, MLAs, officials, local bodies **as the 1975 Act lists**. Recommends prosecution / removal — **not** a criminal court and **not** a substitute for the Allahabad HC
- There is **no** all-India Lokayukta. Whether the **CM** is in = read the **UP Act**, do not copy the Lokpal's PM filter

> **Logic:** First Lokayukta State = **Maharashtra 1971**. UP Act **1975**. 2013 Union Act asked States to have one — UP already did.

Uttar Pradesh Panchayati Raj

Three tiers: Gram Panchayat (Pradhan) → **Kshetra Panchayat** (Pramukh) → Zila Panchayat (Adhyaksha). Statutes: **1947** village Act · **1961** Kshetra–Zila Act.

- Nyaya Panchayats lived in the 1947 Act — **not** a 73rd tier
- Gram ward members = **Panches**. **75** Zila Panchayats (one per district). Kshetra Panchayats ≈ one per development block. Gram Panchayats = tens of thousands — **do not freeze a headcount**
- Women **50%** of seats **and** of Pradhan / chair offices — **State law**. Constitution's floor (243D) is still **≥ 1/3**
- Age **21** (243F), not 25. Term **5 years** from the first meeting
- Officials: village secretary / GPO · **BDO** with the Kshetra · **CDO / CEO** with the Zila Panchayat
- **Gram Sabha (243A):** all **persons on the electoral roll** of that Gram Panchayat — not "every resident", not the Panches sitting (बैठक) as a board. Powers = **State law**

- **DPC (243ZD):** every district. At least **4/5** elected from PRI + ULB members. Consolidates rural **and** urban draft plans
- **PESA does not apply** — UP has **no Fifth Schedule** areas. **6th Schedule** (6वीं अनुसूची) does not apply (ADCs = Assam, Meghalaya (मेघालय), Tripura, Mizoram)

> **Logic:** UP's middle tier is **Kshetra Panchayat**, not Panchayat Samiti (पंचायत समिति). Nyaya Panchayat ≠ a 73rd tier. Constitution's women floor is **1/3**; **50%** is UP's statute.

Urban Local Bodies in Uttar Pradesh

Three 74th types: Nagar Panchayat (transitional) · Nagar Palika Parishad (smaller urban) · Nagar Nigam (larger urban). Statutes: **1916** Municipalities Act · **1959** Municipal Corporation Act.

- Nagar Nigams: Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Varanasi, Prayagraj, Meerut, Ghaziabad, Bareilly, Aligarh, Moradabad, Saharanpur, Gorakhpur, Firozabad, Jhansi, Shahjahanpur (शाहजहाँपुर), Mathura (मथुरा), Ayodhya — **the roster grows**. Mark **types**, not a frozen headcount
- **Mayor** = political head. **Nagar Ayukt / Municipal Commissioner (नगर आयुक्त)** = State-appointed **executive**
- Same skeleton as PRIs: age **21**, term **5 years**, women **50%** by State law. Elections: same **UP SEC** (243ZA)
- **Not 74th:Cantonment Board (छावनी बोर्ड)** (Defence) · **Lucknow Development Authority** and other DAs = master plan / land, **not** the municipality
- **Industrial township (243Q):** if an industrial township provides municipal services, a municipality **need not** be constituted. **Noida, Greater Noida, Yamuna (यमुना) Expressway (YEIDA)** authorities live here — they are **not** Nagar Nigams and their boards are **not** elected by the UP SEC
- **MPC:** million-plus urban agglomerations: Metropolitan Planning Committee, at least **2/3** elected (Lucknow / Kanpur / Ghaziabad class)
- **Ward Committees (243S):** compulsory in a municipality of **3 lakh+**. **Not** a fourth 74th type

> **Logic:** Nagar Nigam polls = **SEC**, not ECI. Mayor ≠ executive (that is the **Commissioner**). Cantonment = **Defence**. **Noida is not a Nagar Nigam.**

Mains link (one frame)

Numbers map = 403 / 100 / 80 / 31 · Lucknow runs the government · Prayagraj runs the HC **and UPPSC** · Uttarakhand **9 Nov 2000**. **Third-tier map** = local polls in **Lucknow** (SEC, HC-judge removal); the **same** SFC feeds villages and towns; Lokayukta is **1975**, not a 2013 import. Close with: **Kshetra not Samiti**; **Pradhan / Pramukh / Adhyaksha**; **Mayor ≠ Commissioner**; **Noida ≠ Nigam**; **no PESA / no 371**; **50% women is State law, 1/3 is the Constitution**; **CoM ≈ 60**; **17 SC / 0 ST in the 80 LS seats**.